

CUSCUS AND RELATIVES

The family Phalangeridae includes cuscuses, brushtail possums, and their relatives. Most members are arboreal, with an opposable thumb on the hind limbs and a prehensile tail. In cuscuses, part or all of the tail is naked, whereas in brushtail possums the tail has fur.

42–74 cm
16½–29 in



COMMON SPOTTED CUSCUS

Spilocuscus maculatus
This cuscus is sexually dimorphic (males and females look different) – only the male has spots. It lives in the rainforests of New Guinea and N.E. Australia.

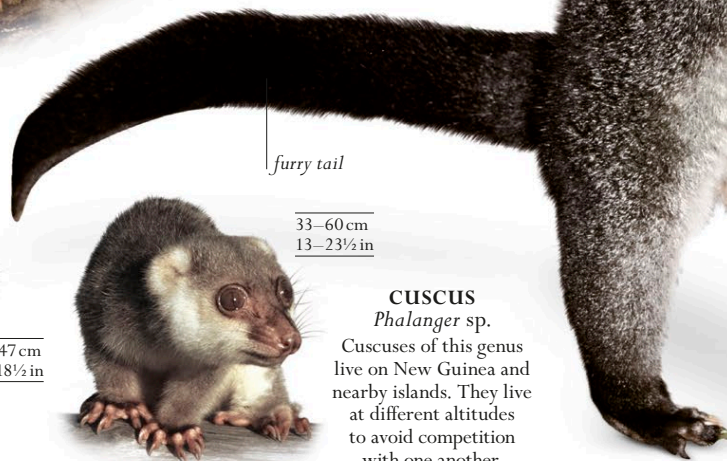
strong,
curved claws



SCALY-TAILED POSSUM

Wyulda squamicaudata
Found only in the Kimberley in N.W. Australia, this nocturnal possum is solitary and bears just one young at a time.

30–47 cm
12–18½ in



furry tail

33–60 cm
13–23½ in

CUSCUS

Phalanger sp.
Cuscuses of this genus live on New Guinea and nearby islands. They live at different altitudes to avoid competition with one another.

SULAWESI BEAR CUSCUS

Ailurops ursinus
The largest of the cuscuses, this species inhabits the canopy of temperate rainforest in Sulawesi and several other Indonesian islands.

large eyes assist
sight at night

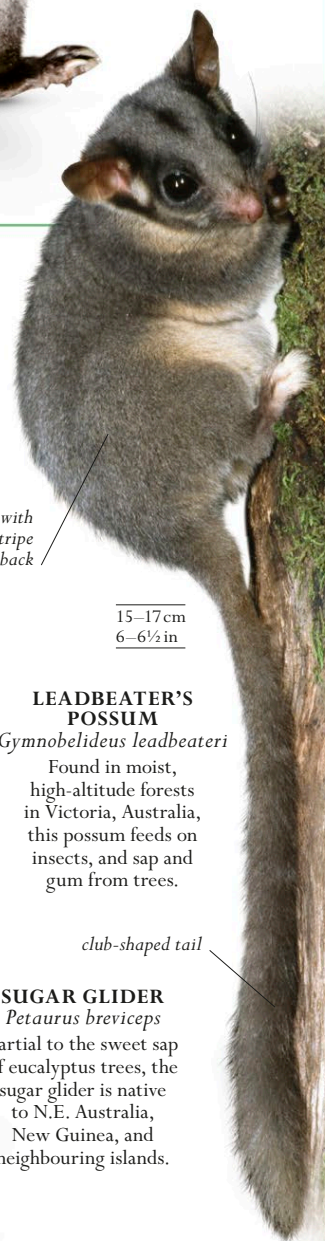


47–57 cm
18½–22½ in

MOUNTAIN BRUSHTAIL POSSUM

Trichosurus cunninghami
The mountain brushtail possum inhabits dense, wet forests in S.E. Australia, typically living at altitudes above 300 m (985 ft).

49–54 cm
19½–21½ in



grey body with
dark stripe
along its back

15–17 cm
6–6½ in

LEADBEATER'S POSSUM

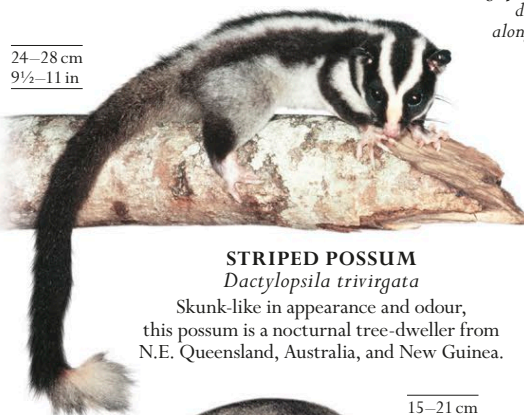
Gymnobelideus leadbeateri
Found in moist, high-altitude forests in Victoria, Australia, this possum feeds on insects, and sap and gum from trees.

club-shaped tail

GLIDING AND STRIPED POSSUMS

The Petauridae include striped possums and gliders, except the greater glider (left). Gliders have a thin, furred membrane between their fore and hind limbs. Striped possums emit strong smells and have an elongated fourth finger to probe for wood-boring beetles.

24–28 cm
9½–11 in

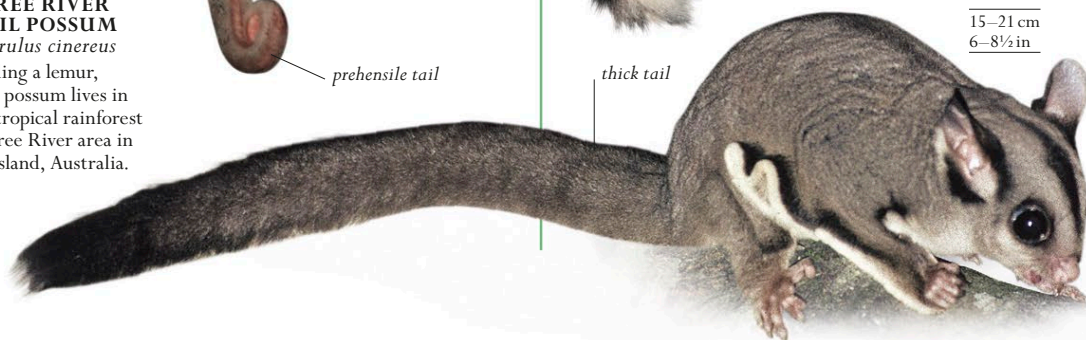


STRIPED POSSUM

Dactylopsila trivirgata
Skunk-like in appearance and odour, this possum is a nocturnal tree-dweller from N.E. Queensland, Australia, and New Guinea.

15–21 cm
6–8½ in

thick tail



GREEN RINGTAIL

Pseudochirops archeri
Named for its thick, greenish fur, this solitary possum is found only in rainforest in the far north of Queensland, Australia.

prehensile tail

grizzled,
grey fur



34–45 cm
13½–18 in

GREATER GLIDER

Petauroides volans
The largest gliding marsupial, this species can travel distances of over 100 m (330 ft) between trees. It lives in E. Australia.

DAINTREE RIVER RINGTAIL POSSUM

Pseudochirulus cinereus
Resembling a lemur, this ringtail possum lives in the montane tropical rainforest in the Daintree River area in N.E. Queensland, Australia.

34–37 cm
13½–14½ in

